within i t . . . . India here set out on a quest which she has never ceased to follow.'

Yet behind the Rig V e d a itself lay ages of civilized existence a n d thought, during which the Indus Valley and the Meso-potamian and other civilizations h a d grown. It is appropriate, therefore, that there should be this dedication in the Rig V e d a : ' T o the Seers, our ancestors, the first path-finders!'

These Vedic hymns have been described by R a b i n d r a n a t h Tagore as 'a poetic testament of a people's collective reaction to the wonder and awe of existence. A people of vigorous and unsophisticated imagination awakened at the very dawn of civi-lization to a sense of the inexhaustible mystery that is implicit in life. It was a simple faith of theirs that attributed divinity to every element and force of nature, but it was a brave and joyous one, in which the sense of mystery only gave enchantment to life, without weighing it down with bafflement—the faith of a

race unburdened with intellectual brooding on the conflicting diversity of the objective universe, though now and again illu-mined by intuitive experience as: " T r u t h is one: (though) the